

ADOBE PHOTOSHOP

Fix The Colour

 When opening graphics in Photoshop, Web designers will notice drastic colour shifts. The new colour management system in Photoshop reinterprets files by default. If you work with Web graphics, you need to turn this feature off. Go to **File > Color Settings > Profile Setup**. Under 'Embed Profiles', un-check 'RGB', and under assumed profiles, select 'None' from the RGB dropdown. Under 'Profile Mismatch Handling', select 'Ignore'.

Photoshop 7 Easter Egg

 Hold down [Ctrl] and [Alt] and click on **Help > About Photoshop**. When the 'Strange Cargo' splash screen appears, type in 'burp' and the crate will open slightly with a big electric cat peeking out. Type the cat's name, "Udo", to hear him meow. Press [Alt] to speed up the scrolling credits. Scroll to the end of the credits to see a name you will recognise. 'Strange Cargo' and 'Big Electric Cat' were the codenames for Photoshop 5 and 4 respectively while they were being developed.

A Full Scratch

 If you get a warning that says, "Your scratch disk is full," you can free up some space by saving the file. However, sometimes Photoshop will not let you save the file. To remedy this, create a small file, say 3x3 pixels, and save it in the Photoshop format. Photoshop will now flush the scratch, and you will be able to save the previous file that you were working on.

Logo Stamp

 If you have an image that you use over and over again, such as a logo or signature, you should make it into a brush. When creating custom brushes from image files, Photoshop saves the image on your 'Brushes' palette. Select the image, click on the Menu arrow on the 'Brushes' palette and select 'Define Brush'. The image now appears on the palette.

Tips & Tricks

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You can use it just as you do with other brushes.

Save Photos As GIFs

 Photoshop has improved its index colour conversions, which allows for higher quality 8-bit, 256-colour conversions from 24-bit images. Although photographs are normally saved as JPG images, the improved colour conversion will let you convert them to GIFs for Web use. This

reduced file size will still retain image quality. To save an image as GIF, go to **File > Export > GIF89a Export**.

3D Transform

 The new 3D Transform plugin lets you work with 2D images as if they were solid 3D objects, so you can adjust the perspective on an image from straight-on to various angles. Click on **Filter > Render > 3D Transform**. Draw a wire-frame over your image and use the Pan

Camera and Trackball tools to manipulate the image perspective, and click OK.

Make It An Action Item

 Actions automate routine tasks and save a lot of time. To create an 'Action', click on the 'Menu' arrow on the 'Action' palette and click on 'New Action'. Click 'Record' to start recording and carry out all the steps for the action you perform regularly. Once you're done, click on the 'Stop' button on the Action palette. To repeat the action, select it and click on the Play button on the palette.

Make Your Images Fit

 The 'Fit Image' command resizes an image to fit within a given area without altering its aspect ratio. Click on **File > Automate > Fit Image**. Enter a new width or height and click 'OK' to resize the image.

Memory Errors

 Sometimes, Photoshop reports an 'Out of Memory Error'. Just acknowledge the dialog box and select **Edit > Purge > All** (or Undo, Pattern, Clipboard, and/or Histories).

Open your 'System Properties' (Virtual Memory Settings) by going to **Start > Settings > Control Panel > System**, and under the Performance tab, clicking the button labelled 'Virtual Memory'. Change your minimum and maximum virtual memory settings to two-and-a-half times your RAM—for example, if you have 256 MB of RAM, enter 640 in both fields. Ignore the Windows warning that pops up!

Now, in Photoshop's preferences ([Ctrl] + [K]), under 'Memory & Image Cache' ([Ctrl] + [8], or **File >**

Bet You Didn't Know

Centre An Object

If you need to position an image at the centre of the canvas, there's no need to calculate image parameters and reorganise the image. All you have to do is to cut the object and paste it back.



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